ETCSL 5.2.5 — The poem of early rulers

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.5.2.5&display=Crit&charenc=gcirc ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.5.2.5 ; XML from OTA 2518 (see `../_bulk/`). ORACC: https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/literary/Q000789
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16 (live site down; HTML from Wayback Machine raw captures; XML from Oxford Text Archive)
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Why it matters here

The "Ballad of Early Rulers" (Sumerian version from Sippar; bilingual versions known from Emar and Ugarit): "…he who, **like Ziusudra, sought life**?" (l. 10) — Ziusudra as the proverbial man who gained eternal life, alongside Alulu, Etana and Gilgameš. The ETCSL translation page t.5.2.5 was not archived; the translation is in translation.md (from the XML).

Files

- `b525--etcsl-bibliography.htm`
- `c.5.2.5--etcsl-cgi-transliteration.html`
- `c.5.2.5.xml`
- `t.5.2.5.xml`
- `translation.md`
- `transliteration.md`

`transliteration.md` (16 composite lines) and `translation.md` are clean UTF-8 conversions of the XML (conventions at the top of each file); the `.xml` files are the authoritative source; the `--etcsl-cgi-*.html` files are the website display (Unicode, edition 2).

Line numbering

ETCSL composite line numbers (with segments/versions where the composition has them). Translation paragraphs carry the line range they cover.

ETCSL bibliography (secondary literature, from the XML header)

- Krecher 1996 composite text electronic source
- Alster 1990c score transliteration, translation, commentary no. 4
- Alster 1986 score transliteration, translation, commentary

Manuscripts listed by ETCSL

- BM 80091 (ASJ 8 10-11) rev. ii 94-98
- BM 80184 (CT 44 18) rev. ii 83'-98'
- CBS 1208 rev. ii 95-98

Assessment

Standard free composite with translation; frozen in 2006 — check for newer manuscripts/editions (see `../../ORACC/` and the notes above).